



Wow! How creative!



Primates with DSLRs!

tion growth projections. The dSLR share of the billions of pictures we are exposed to is miniscule, and falling. Actually camera sales of all categories (except smartphones) is falling.

Whether we like it or not, the camera heydays are over, as most of us are relying on our phones to do our photography. Camera manufacturers are going to cut jobs even more massively than before, and will totally focus on the professional segment, which means higher prices, and less innovation and choice for entry- to medium-level equipment. In essence it's a total 180 of the previous trend of trying to put a camera in every hand. But is that bad? Not for me. No one wants to see the average Jogesh pull out a DSLR, get on his knees and photograph his girlfriend in front of some monument, using the standard perspective trick.

FLOODING

Social media, apps like SnapChat, and all of the standard things we click photographs for have flooded our brains with so much imagery, that we just cannot tell good from bad anymore. We're just numb to the medium itself. If all you saw everywhere were oil paintings everywhere you went, by every person you ever encountered online, offline, and even randomly all over, would you truly appreciate a Van Gogh, Rembrandt or da Vinci when you saw one?

And it's not just photographs, but memes that we're exposed to. In fact, memes are typically badly drawn on purpose (or because of lack of skill, I don't know), but the point is they're meant to stick out by being ridiculous.

CREATIONISTS?

Another excuse made for the other side is the whole "art is changing" spiel. You know, like Picasso and the likes changed art from realism to whatever the heck that nonsense on display in modern art museums is. My side of the argument will likely be called the side that's resistant to change, like old fogeys shaking their sticks at these young whippersnappers who are always on their phones. More playing hide the ball – because the art of photography can't actually change. Unlike painting, where the creation is in the artist's mind, photography is about finding the right moment, the right angle, the right subject, the right lighting, and all of the above. "Creation" of imagery is graphic design, not photography. The art of photography has never, and will never change. What is changing is our likes and dislikes and how we see the world.

Narcissism is the real problem. Social media has put us in the center, and made us want to project something to the world. Without really

making any value judgements about whether this is good or bad, it's diametrically opposite from the ethos of the photography art form. Professional photographers take great pains to try and be flies on walls, whereas we are the opposite. We're constantly in the shot, front and center, and it's always about us – no art will ever be made using a selfie stick. In fact, in some places, you can't even go in and view the art if you are using a selfie stick! **

THE STRUGGLE

Then there's the whole problem of the actual *job* of photographer dying out. Videographers certainly not, but photographers are certainly suffering. If you ignore the typical strawman argument that can be propped up to showcase the top professionals in their field, and focus on people who make (made?) their bread and butter by shooting images, you will find that jobs are drying up. Taking Digit itself as an example, in the past decade we've gone from a photography team of three full-time photographers to one part-time individual. Why? Because we found that you (our readers) didn't appreciate the effort we used to put in to photograph every single product that came in through our test center. One day we switched to using press images, and nothing. Crickets chirping. It's like no one even noticed the change... For online, reviewers just click images from their phones, because the art of staging a product is considered to be the manufacturer's job, not ours.

Wedding photographers, studio photographers, product photographers, food photographers... you name it, they're all a dying breed. Companies prefer to hire people who can do some other job, and happen to enjoy photography as a hobby. It's gradually taken a backseat, because even smartphone photography is considered "good enough" for most purposes. This is not any businesses' doing, it's yours. Again, I make no value judgements, but the fact is good creative photography doesn't seem to matter to most people, all it needs to be is informative.

If we were to do that for Digit, it would be akin to you being given data and facts to interpret, the way it is presented in a text book... If all of us so called "creative writers" for magazines, books and sites were losing our jobs, sales of aforementioned books and magazines, and visitors to sites were dropping drastically, and you (the readers) didn't care because you were fine with getting textbook like information, would you say the art of writing was thriving? I think not. The same goes for the art of photography... we've killed it, or certainly relegated it back to being niche. **[4]**

** Take a look at:
<http://dgit.in/SelfiBan>